

Loveliest of trees

Text: A. E. Housman, 1896

Music: Pierre de Corbeil, harmonized Richard Redhead, 1853

ORIENTIS PARTIBUS 77.77

The musical score is written for a three-part setting (Soprano, Alto, and Tenor/Bass) in 3/4 time. The key signature has three flats (B-flat, E-flat, A-flat). The score is divided into four systems, each with a treble and bass staff. The lyrics are written below the staves, with some words hyphenated across measures. Chord symbols are placed above the staves: Eb, Fm, Bb, Eb in the first system; Eb, Ab, Bbsus, Bb, Eb in the second; Ab, Fm, G in the third; and Eb/G, Gm, Fm, Bb, Eb in the fourth. The piece concludes with a double bar line.

1 Love - liest of trees, the cher - ry now,
2 Now of my three - score years and ten,
3 And since to look at things in bloom

hung with bloom a - long the bough,
tween - ty will not come a - gain.
fif - ty springs are lit - tle room,

it stands a - bout the wood - land ride
And take from sev'n - ty springs a score,
a - bout the wood - lands I will go,

wear - ing white for Eas - ter - tide.
leav - ing me just fif - ty more.
see the cher - ry hung with snow.